Jeffy Loop

Description and Operation
Standard: ASD-STE100 Simplified Technical English | Date: 2026-10-12

1. General

Jeffy Loop is a skill for Claude Code. It finds defects in a codebase and repairs them. It makes sure that each repair is correct before it commits the change. It does not push changes.

2. Components

Component	Function
`/jeffy` **skill**	Starts the loop.
`PLAN.md`	Contains the goal, the limits, the list of public surface, the test command, and the lessons.
`BACKLOG.md`	Contains the tasks. The most serious task is first.
`JOURNAL.md`	Contains a record of each iteration. The loop adds records. It does not remove records.
Stop hook (`stop-hook.sh`**)**	A shell script. It starts each new iteration. It also examines the conditions for the end of the run.
Evaluator	A second AI agent with a new context. It examines the work of the run and gives PASS or REJECT.
`.jeffy/` **directory**	Contains test probes and evaluator records.
`/cancel-jeffy` **skill**	Stops the loop.

3. Operation

3.1 Start

1. Open Claude Code in the project.
2. Type `/jeffy 10`. The number is the maximum number of iterations.
3. The loop makes the three state files at the project root. These files stay after the run.

3.2 First audit

1. The loop makes a list of all of the public surface of the code.
2. The loop examines each item on the list.
3. For each defect, the loop writes a task in `BACKLOG.md`.
4. Each task must have a test that runs. If the loop cannot show the defect, the defect is not a task.

3.3 Each iteration

1. The loop does one task only.
2. The loop runs the test for that task.
3. The loop runs the project test command from `PLAN.md`.
4. If the change breaks the tests, the loop removes the change. The task becomes "blocked".
5. If the loop tries a task three times and it fails, the task becomes "blocked".
6. The loop makes a local commit. The commit name starts with `jeffy:`.
7. At the end of the iteration, the Stop hook starts the next iteration.

3.4 End of the run

The run stops for one of these conditions:

- Convergence (refer to 3.5).
- No more iterations in the budget.
- Two iterations in sequence with no progress.
- A blocker.
- The operator types `/cancel-jeffy`.

3.5 Convergence

Convergence is possible only when all of these conditions are true:

1. A new audit finds zero High and zero Medium defects.
2. The loop examined all items on the surface list.
3. The evaluator gives PASS.
4. The project tests pass.

The Stop hook examines these conditions in shell. If one condition is false, the hook does not let the run stop. If a code item changes, the hook marks that item as not examined again.

The evaluator can examine one run two times only. If the evaluator gives REJECT and no more examinations are available, the run stops as "blocked".

4. High Hunt Mode

1. Type `/jeffy 5 --highs`.
2. The loop repairs High defects only.
3. The loop stops at the first audit that finds no High defects.
4. This mode does not use the evaluator. It does not declare convergence.

5. Safety

- The loop does not push changes.
- The loop does not make branches.

> **WARNING**
>
> Do not let the loop push or force-push.
>
> Do not add these operations to the allowlist.

6. Recommendations

- Use short runs. Start a new session for each run. A new session gives the loop a clean context.
- Do not change `PLAN.md` or `BACKLOG.md` during an iteration. Change them between runs only.